



Feathered tail of a dinosaur

A 99 million year-old tail, with feathers preserved, of a dinosaur was found in Amber in Myanmar, Southeast Asia. <http://dgit.in/dinoAmbr>



Microsoft's LinkedIn acquisition

Software giant Microsoft finalises a whopping \$26 billion acquisition deal for LinkedIn. <http://dgit.in/McrsftLnkd>

Workshop

UPI works by partnering with the banks in India and every customer is directly linked to their bank accounts. Unlike wallet services such as Paytm or FreeCharge, UPI is not a wallet. There is no intermediary where the money is stored for transactions. Instead, all the transactions happen directly through the bank accounts.

While not all banks have completely implemented UPI, there are a few which have released applications already. A customer of the bank would have to download the application and obtain a unique address, which is the only thing that needs to be shared in a transaction. Unlike bitcoins, the transactions are not anonymous, and there is always a record of these transactions.

The organization behind UPI is the NPCI or National Payments Corporation of India. If you've ever used IMPS (Immediate Payment Service), UPI is an advanced version of IMPS. "Today a few banks have gone live with UPI out of 29 banks that had

numbers and names, and you can have multiple virtual addresses at multiple banks. For example, a virtual address looks something like this digit@sbi. Here, 'digit' is a string that you can select, something like a username. Instead of a username, you can also use your phone number as 1234567890@sbi. The second part of the virtual address specifies the bank in which the customer holds the account. Each bank has a short code, which can be used here. The virtual address is the only information you'll need to initiate the transaction. This is incredibly useful for retail applications where it is often inconvenient to accept payments through traditional Net Banking. A shop owner can simply store the virtual address in any medium such as QR Codes, NFC tags, RFID chips, Beacons etc. UPI also lets you initiate a payment request to a virtual address, like

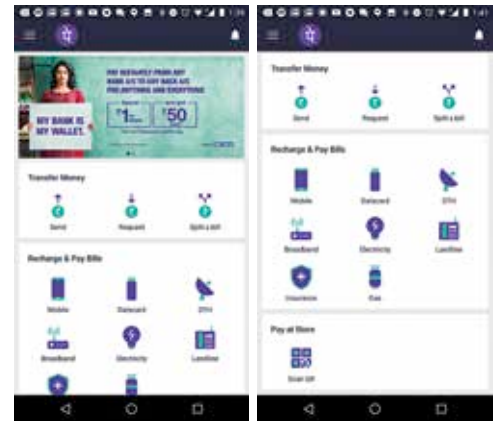
several wallet apps. The person requesting must only type the virtual address and communicate the URL to the other person by any media such as physical media or digitally.

According to the NPCI, a merchant PoS (Point of Sale) application could create the UPI link with the correct parameters as specified and then transmit using sound to the customer device. Customer app or a utility app can listen to that sound, convert it back to the link, and then launch the UPI application on customer phone to make the payment. The URL format is described as:

`upi://pay?parm-name=param-value¶m-name=param-value&...`

UPI also encourages deep-linking within apps, so services can invoke UPI apps which are listening on a user's phone to initiate a transaction. We now delve into the procedure for using UPI on most android and iOS phones, and

a limited set of participating banks. For now, the banks which have gotten the approval from Apple for UPI transactions include Andhra Bank, Axis Bank, Bank of Maharashtra, Bhartiya Mahila Bank, Canara Bank, Catholic Syrian



We used PhonePe to try out UPI

Bank, DCB Bank, Federal Bank, ICICI Bank, TJSB Sahakari Bank, Oriental Bank of Commerce, Karnataka Bank, UCO Bank, Union Bank of India, United Bank of India, Punjab National Bank, South Indian Bank, Vijaya Bank and YES Bank. If you have an account in any of these banks, you can begin using UPI right away. If your bank isn't participating yet, you should contact your nearest branch.

Do you really need UPI?

While the prospect of UPI sounds interesting and exciting for digital payments, you wouldn't be using it much unless there is widespread adoption. Very few merchants and businesses are aware of UPI and it is best to determine if your use case matches with the objectives of UPI. UPI can be substituted with a lot of other services such as credit/debit cards, net banking, payment wallets and blockchain currencies. So, if your needs can be serviced by one of these services, you can ignore UPI.

How to get started:

Since UPI is built on a mobile first platform, you can download your respective bank's UPI app from the Google Play Store or the iOS App Store. You



concluded to provide UPI service to their customers. We are confident that several banks will join UPI this year and the number will multiply further. Our focus is in line with RBI's vision of migrating towards 'less-cash' and more digital society. NPCI has always been at the forefront to innovate and introduce new products and services at par with global standards," said A. P. Hota, MD & CEO, NPCI. By allowing the user to create a virtual address like an email address, the virtual address can be given out in the public for people to transact. To send and receive money through UPI, you'll need a virtual address which can be obtained from supporting banks. Only the banks have an internal database, that links the virtual addresses to account